

Word family: **make / made / making**

Base word: make

Past tense: made

Past participle: made

Related form: making

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “What **made** it effective was that it did not try too hard.”

Meaning in this passage

Meaning: To cause something to have a particular quality or become a particular way.

繁體中文: **使某事物產生某種特質、變成某種狀態**

中文翻譯:

「令這則廣告**變得有效**的原因, 是它沒有刻意過度推銷。」

make + object + adjective = 使.....變得.....

1. **make + object + adjective (事物／人物 + 狀態或特質) — 使.....變得.....**

Meaning: To cause someone or something to have a particular quality, feeling, or condition.

Practice 1 — Original

> “What **made** it effective was that it did not try too hard.”

「**令它變得有效**的原因, 是它沒有過分刻意。」

Practice 2

> “The soft lighting **made** the room more comfortable.”

「柔和的燈光**令房間變得更舒適**。」

Practice 3

> “The long commute **made** me exhausted.”

「漫長的通勤**令我變得筋疲力盡**。」

****make + object + adjective = 使某人／某物產生某種狀態或特質****

2. ****make + person + verb (某人 + 動作) — 使／迫使某人做某事****

****Meaning:**** To cause or require someone to do something.

Practice 4

> “The advertisement ****made**** me think about buying the product.”

「那則廣告**令我開始考慮購買**那件產品。」

Practice 5

> “The teacher ****made**** the students rewrite the paragraph.”

「老師**要求學生重寫**那一段。」

****make someone do something = 使／要求／迫使某人做某事****

Important grammar:

> ****make someone do**** 

> not ****make someone to do**** 

3. ****make + product/object (產品／物件) — 製造；製作；創造****

****Meaning:**** To create or produce a physical object or product.

Practice 6

> “This company ****makes**** headphones.”

「這家公司**製造**耳機。」

Practice 7

> “The table was **made** by hand.”

「這張桌子是**人手製作**的。」

make = 製造／製作某件實體物品

4. **make + food/drink (食物／飲品) — 準備; 製作**

Meaning: To prepare food or a drink.

Practice 8

> “I’ll **make** some coffee.”

「我去**沖一些咖啡**。」

Practice 9

> “She **made** dinner for the family.”

「她為家人**準備了晚餐**。」

make food/drink = 準備／製作食物或飲品

This is still related to “create,” but it is common enough to teach as a clear everyday pattern.

5. **make + decision/choice/plan/effort/mistake (決定／選擇／計劃／努力／錯誤等) — 作出; 進行; 犯**

Meaning: To perform or produce an action expressed by a noun.

The Chinese translation changes according to the noun.

Practice 10

> “We need to **make** a decision today.”

「我們今天需要**作出決定**。」

Practice 11

> “He **made** a serious mistake.”

「他**犯**了一個嚴重錯誤。」

Common patterns:

* **make a decision** = 作出決定

* **make a choice** = 作出選擇

* **make a plan** = 制定計劃

* **make an effort** = 作出努力

* **make a mistake** = 犯錯

* **make a suggestion** = 提出建議

* **make a complaint** = 提出投訴

make + action noun = 進行／作出該項行動

6. **make + money/profit/income** (金錢／利潤／收入) — 賺取; 獲得

Meaning: To earn money or produce a financial profit.

Practice 12

> “She **makes** a good salary.”

「她**賺取**不錯的薪金。」

Practice 13

> “The company **made** a large profit last year.”

「公司去年**錄得／賺取**了很大的利潤。」

make money/profit = 賺取金錢／取得利潤

7. **make + amount/number** (總數／數值) — 合計為; 等於

Meaning: To add up to or equal a particular total.

Practice 14

> “Two plus three ****makes**** five.”

「二加三****等於****五。」

Practice 15

> “The two payments together ****make**** \$1,000.”

「兩筆款項加起來****合共是**** 1,000 元。」

****make = 合計為／等於某個數值****

8. ****make + group/whole (群體／整體) — 組成;構成****

****Meaning:**** For people or things together to form a larger whole.

Practice 16

> “Ten employees ****make**** a complete team.”

「十名員工****組成****一個完整團隊。」

Practice 17

> “These small details ****make**** the overall design.”

「這些小細節共同****構成****整體設計。」

****make = 多個部分共同組成某個整體****

9. ****make + person + role/title (某人 + 職位／身分) — 任命為;使成為****

****Meaning:**** To appoint someone to a role or cause them to become something.

Practice 18

> “They ****made**** her team leader.”

「他們****任命她為****團隊主管。」

Practice 19

> “The board **made** him chairman.”

「董事會**任命**他為**主席**。」

make someone + role = 任命某人擔任某職位／使某人成為某身分

This differs from #1 because the complement is a **role/noun**, not merely a quality like *happy* or *effective*.

10. **make + person/thing + noun** (使某人成為某類型的人／使某物成為某種事物) — 使成為.....

Meaning: To cause someone or something to develop into or function as a particular type of person or thing.

Practice 20

> “Her patience **makes** her a good teacher.”

「她的耐性**使**她成為一位好老師。」

Practice 21

> “The large windows **make** this room an ideal meeting space.”

「大窗戶**令**這個房間成為理想的會議空間。」

make + object + noun = 使某人／某物成為某種類型或身分

11. **make + destination/event/transport** (目的地／活動／交通班次) — 成功趕到；及時到達

Meaning: To succeed in reaching a place, attending an event, or catching scheduled transport in time.

Practice 22

> “I don’t think I can **make** the 6:00 train.”

「我想我未必能**及時趕上**六點的火車。」

Practice 23

> “Can you **make** the meeting tomorrow?”

「你明天能**趕到／出席**會議嗎？」

make + destination/event = 成功在所需時間內到達或出席

12. **make + time/distance/speed (時間／距離／速度) — 達到; 完成**

Meaning: To achieve a particular time, distance, or speed.

Practice 24

> “The runner **made** the distance in under an hour.”

「那名跑手在一小時內**完成了**那段距離。」

Practice 25

> “The car can **make** 200 kilometres per hour.”

「這輛車的速度可以**達到**每小時 200 公里。」

make = 成功達到某個時間、距離或速度

13. **make + bed (床鋪) — 整理床鋪**

Meaning: To arrange the sheets, blankets, and pillows neatly after sleeping.

Practice 26

> “Please **make** your bed before you leave.”

「離開前請**整理好床鋪**。」

Practice 27

> “She **made** the bed as soon as she got up.”

「她一起床便**整理床鋪**。」

****make the bed = 把被鋪、床單和枕頭整理整齊****

This is a fixed ordinary use of ****make****, not “manufacture a bed.”

14. ****make + sound/noise/comment/gesture (聲音／評論／動作等) — 發出; 作出****

****Meaning:**** To produce a sound, remark, movement, or similar expression.

Practice 28

> “The machine ****made**** a strange noise.”

「機器****發出****了奇怪的聲音。」

Practice 29

> “She ****made**** a brief comment about the advertisement.”

「她對那則廣告****作出了****簡短評論。」

****make = 發出聲音／作出某種表達或動作****

This overlaps with “produce,” but the pattern is useful because Chinese typically uses verbs such as ****發出／作出**** rather than 「製造」.

15. ****make + change/improvement/progress (改變／改善／進展) — 作出; 取得****

****Meaning:**** To cause or achieve a change, improvement, or progress.

Practice 30

> “We need to ****make**** some changes to the design.”

「我們需要對設計****作出一些改動****。」

Practice 31

> “She has ****made**** excellent progress in English.”

「她的英文已經****取得很大的進步****。」

****make = 作出改變／取得進展****

Semantically this belongs to the broad “produce/bring about” family, but the collocation is important for learners.

16. ****make + impression/difference/impact(印象／差異／影響) — 產生;造成****

****Meaning:**** To produce a noticeable effect on someone or something.

Practice 32

> “The advertisement ****made**** a strong impression on me.”

「那則廣告給我****留下了深刻印象****。」

Practice 33

> “A small change can ****make**** a big difference.”

「一個小改變也可以****造成很大的差別****。」

****make = 產生／造成某種影響、差異或印象****

17. ****make = calculate/judge something to be(估計／判斷為某數值或情況) — 估計;判斷****

****Meaning:**** To calculate or judge something as being a particular amount or state.

Practice 34

> “I ****make**** the total about \$500.”

「我****估計****總數大約是 500 元。」

Practice 35

> “What do you ****make**** the distance?”

「你****估計****這段距離有多遠？」

****make = 根據計算或判斷估計某個數值／情況****

This use is especially common in British English.

18. **make** = brand/manufacture (產品的製造品牌) — 品牌; 製造商

Here, **make** is a noun.

Meaning: The company or brand that manufactured a product, especially a vehicle or machine.

Practice 36

> “What **make** is your car?”

「你的車是甚麼**品牌**？」

Practice 37

> “I prefer this **make** of camera.”

「我比較喜歡這個**品牌／廠牌**的相機。」

make = 製造某產品的品牌／廠牌

19. **making** = process of creating/producing something (製作某物的過程) — 製作; 生產

Here, **making** is a noun.

Practice 38

> “The documentary shows the **making** of the film.”

「這部紀錄片展示了電影的**製作過程**。」

Practice 39

> “Traditional methods are still used in the **making** of this product.”

「這件產品的**製作過程**仍然採用傳統方法。」

making = 某物被創造／製作出來的過程

Important distinction: **make vs do**

These two are often confused.

make

Usually focuses on **creating, producing, causing, or bringing something into existence/result**.

> **make a cake**

> 製作蛋糕

> **make a decision**

> 作出決定

> **make me happy**

> 令我開心

do

Usually focuses on **performing an activity, task, duty, or work**.

> **do homework**

> 做功課

> **do the cleaning**

> 做清潔

> **do your job**

> 做好你的工作

Important distinction: causative patterns

make + object + adjective

> “The music **made me relaxed**.”

「音樂**令我放鬆**。」

make + person + verb

> “The teacher **made me rewrite it.**”

「老師**要我重寫**。」

make + person + noun

> “They **made her manager.**”

「他們**任命她為經理**。」

These are related but grammatically different patterns.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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make + object + adjective	使某人／某物產生某種狀態或特質
make + person + verb	使／要求／迫使某人做某事
make + product/object	製造／製作實體物品
make + food/drink	準備或製作食物／飲品
make + decision/effort/mistake etc.	作出／進行／犯某種行動
make money/profit	賺取金錢／取得利潤
make + amount/number	合計為／等於某個數值
make + group/whole	多個部分共同組成整體
make + person + role	任命某人擔任某職位
make + object + noun	使某人／某物成為某種類型
make + destination/event	成功及時到達或出席
make + time/distance/speed	達到某時間、距離或速度
make the bed	整理床鋪
make + sound/comment/gesture	發出／作出某種聲音、評論或動作
make + change/progress	作出改變／取得進展
make + impression/difference/impact	產生或造成影響、差異、印象
make = estimate/judge	根據計算或判斷估計某數值／情況
make — noun	產品的品牌／製造廠牌
making — noun	某物被創造或製作的過程

For your original sentence

> “What **made** it effective was that it did not try too hard.”

The exact meaning is:

****make + object + adjective = 使某事物產生某種特質或變成某種狀態****

So:

****made it effective = 令它變得有效／使它產生良好效果****